

Write to the Editor

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Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. Please include your complete address in all communication.

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Inbox

LETTER
OF THE
MONTH

field to make this magazine versatile. I request you to please add a networking section in your magazine. You can add this in your *Tech Careers*.

Amit Belwal
Delhi

Dear Amit,

A section on networking doesn't seem too likely, but we'll definitely include networking-related articles in coming issues. And yes, careers in networking is going to feature in the *Tech Careers* section very soon—maybe even the next issue! Do keep the suggestions rolling in—we sometimes get some really good ones.

— Executive Editor

An Art Exhibit

I don't know what art is, but I do know what *Digit* is to all of us. A standing ovation to all of those Tech-Artists whose work we see in the form of *Digit*. The popular saying "The first impression is long lasting" seems true to me because from the day I had touched your art, I really became ADDICTED to it. I would also like to thank all of you for presenting those little wonders which you call *Fast Track*. I would simply say those little books are a fast track to life for all geeks like us.

I don't know whether you are going to read this mail, but I am going to buy your coming issues as I have done in the past. Keep performing your art and we will keep bringing it into our homes.

I have a request to all those people who haven't subscribed to *Digit* yet—please live with *Digit* and you will know what it is.

Kumar Saurabh Kumbhawat
Khagaul

Dear Kumar

You've definitely given us a different way to look at our work—all this time we thought we were just doing our jobs! As you can see, we have indeed read your mail, and we appreciate your joining us in our effort to attract more subscribers.

— Executive Editor

Git Off Yer 'hind!

I'm a regular reader of *Digit*, and it's helped me a lot. You've made me active. You've made me learn XHTML and CSS. And now, thanks to you, I'm learning PHP. Your *Fast Track* series is superb and I have the complete collection of them. The *Fast Track to Web Design* was really awesome. Why was the *Fast Track to The Registry* so thin? Why don't you also give out a *Fast Track to PHP*, *Fast Track to APL* and *Fast Track to Macs*? That will be very cool.

You guys don't cover much on the developer's side. You also have very less coverage on Macs. Why don't you give at least a three to five page coverage on Macs on every issue of *Digit*?

I'm from Nepal. Can I subscribe to your magazine? What about *SKOAR*?

Sanjivanu Marga
Nepal

Dear Sanjivanu

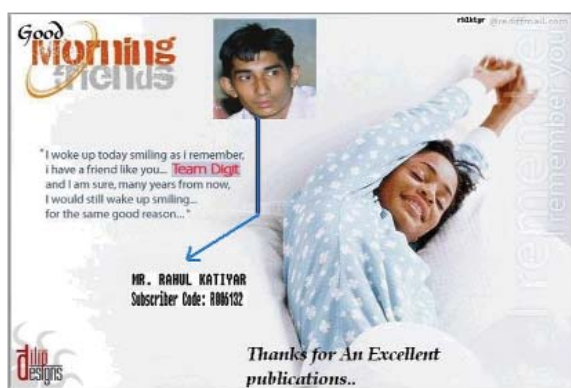
We're glad you've been woken into action by *Digit*. Unfortunately, while we retail in Nepal, you can't subscribe to the magazine just yet. It's something we're working on, and we'll certainly let you know if and when you can subscribe. The same applies to *SKOAR*!

— Executive Editor

Treading A Fine Line

How do I make a drive play DVDs of all seven regions?

Rahul Tyagi



Dear Rahul,

There are methods to make your DVD drive region-free. There is no law against that, but this is a method to protect the movie against piracy. By unlocking your drive, you're opening up the possibility of someone accusing you of piracy. DVDs released in the US are for US audiences only, and the studios will release Indian versions when they feel a movie will do well in India. It's a reality we don't like, but must be abided with.

— Executive Editor

Rants On Piracy

Your magazine as well as its readers are saying to use original or open source software. I know that open source / original software is a need. I would like to focus your sight on the market region as they will tell you how piracy is growing. A recent visit to Delhi—Connaught Place—is also a hotbed of piracy. Palika Bazaar is a market full of pirated CDs. They sell CDs without any fear of the government or any agency that would act against them. They sell those CDs and attract customers as though they were selling fruits and vegetables. In Mumbai, I have seen discs being sold on the streets. I only want to say that piracy has become a worldwide issue. The government is not looking at this matter.

Also, reducing the price of original CDs (movies as well as software) could not even control piracy. New movies released on VCD cost Rs 150 and above. These, when copied, cost around Rs15, so no buyer would be stupid enough to shell out Rs150. Some companies give their VCDs on 800 MB CD-Rs, but those are crackable too. Just selling the original VCD at Rs 150 or above could not even stop piracy. New movies are easily available for download—torrents, P2P, or even via direct download links. Even if you can't download them, it is available in CD parlours and shops.

Digit says that in the upcoming time, you will be forced to buy original software. But Indians are not creating the software, nor cracks or keygens. The *Fast Track to Web Design* has given some good forum software, both paid and open source. All the forums are available free of charge (in nullified script), so how can you control them on the Internet? Banning even IPs for scams or piracy-related things can't stop them from giving their pirated things out in the open. I want to conclude only that it is time the government realised that piracy is a disease that replicates and is destroying the country's economic progress.

I don't think *Digit* will ever produce my letter. But I'm writing this letter for expressing my views against piracy and how it happens in front of the local police and mainly the government.

Kumar Pratik